

Nadia Petrakis

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EDUCATION

Albemoor University

PhD in Ecology

Corvallis, OR

Sep 2019 – Jun 2024

- Dissertation: How birds move seeds into burned forest, and what that means for recovery
- Advisor: Dr. Helen Marsh

Larkbriar University

Bachelor of Science in Biology, minor in Statistics

Raleigh, NC

May 2017

- Graduated summa cum laude; honors thesis on pollinator visits to urban meadow plots

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral Researcher

Cottonhollow University, Department of Forest Sciences

Jul 2024 – Present

Fort Collins, CO

- Lead a three-year study of shrub and tree recovery on 48 plots across two wildfire scars
- Built the lab's R workflow for cleaning plot data and fitting recovery models, which five other projects in the department now use for their own field data
- Mentor two graduate students and four undergraduates; this year two of the undergraduates designed their own small projects and presented posters

Graduate Research Assistant

Albemoor University, Department of Integrative Biology

Sep 2019 – Jun 2024

Corvallis, OR

- Measured seed removal by birds at 60 burned and unburned sites over four field seasons, about 14,000 seed trap checks in all, with a crew of two to five people
- Wrote the field protocol and safety plan for remote burn sites, now the lab's standard
- Ran camera trap surveys with a state wildlife agency and published the cleaned data set

PUBLICATIONS

Petrakis, N., Ruiz, C., & Marsh, H. (2026). Shrub cover predicts tree seedling survival five years after high-severity fire. *Journal of Western Forest Recovery*, 14(2), 88–101.

Petrakis, N., & Marsh, H. (2025). Birds carry seeds farther into severely burned forest than models assume. *Fire and Landscape Ecology*, 9(1), 23–37.

Petrakis, N. (2024). Seed dispersal by birds after wildfire in the Cascade Range. Doctoral dissertation, Albemoor University.

Ruiz, C., Petrakis, N., & Okonjo, D. (2023). A low-cost seed trap for steep, burned slopes. *Methods in Field Ecology*, 6(3), 211–219.

PRESENTATIONS

- Where do the seeds land? Bird movement after wildfire. Western Forest Ecology Symposium, Bozeman, MT, 2025 (invited talk)
- Shrubs as nurseries for burned forest. Rocky Mountain Fire Science Meeting, Denver, CO, 2024
- Poster: Seed traps for steep slopes. Pacific Northwest Ecology Conference, Portland, OR, 2022

TEACHING

Instructor of Record, Field Methods in Ecology

Albemoor University, 24 students

2023

- Rebuilt the course around two weekend field trips and a student-designed final project

Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Ecology

Albemoor University, four terms, labs of about 30 students

2019 – 2022

GRANTS AND AWARDS

- Thornholme Foundation Early Career Fellowship, \$45,000, 2025
- Albemore University Graduate Research Grant, \$6,500, 2022
- Best Student Poster, Pacific Northwest Ecology Conference, 2022

SERVICE

- Peer reviewer for Fire and Landscape Ecology and Methods in Field Ecology
- Graduate student representative on the department hiring committee, 2022 – 2023

SKILLS

Analysis: R (lme4, brms), Python, QGIS

Fieldwork: Seed traps, camera traps, plot surveys

Languages: English (native), Greek (conversational)